

CCAR-P Exam Guide — The Essentials

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github.com/anuragsirish/claude-certified-architect-prep · Free video course · Diary of an AI Architect

Everything you need to know before sitting the **Claude Certified Architect – Professional (CCAR-P)** exam, condensed into a quick read. Written in my own words, based on the official exam guide (v1.0, July 2026) and the official prep path — details can change, so always confirm against the [official certification page](#) before you register.

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What this certification is

CCAR-P validates that you can **design, build, and deliver production-grade AI solutions on the Claude platform** — model and architecture selection, prompt and context engineering, enterprise integration, evaluation, and the security, compliance, and governance thinking that goes with all of it.

Who it's for: mid- to senior-level solution architects, AI/ML engineers, and technical leads who own end-to-end AI systems — not entry-level developers or prompt-only roles.

Recommended experience (recommended, not required — there are no mandatory prerequisites):

- A foundation in software engineering best practices
- 3+ years in systems architecture or platform engineering
- 6+ months hands-on with Claude (or comparable LLM systems) in production
- Experience delivering systems end-to-end, from discovery through operations

Exam at a glance

Exam code	CCAR-P
Questions	63 — multiple-choice and multiple-response (each item tells you how many to select)
Time limit	120 minutes
Delivery	Proctored — online or at a Pearson VUE test center
Passing score	720 on a 100–1,000 scaled range
Fee	\$175 USD per attempt
Validity	12 months
Results	Pass/fail with your scaled score, plus percent-correct per domain

The blueprint — 7 domains

#	Domain	Weight	What it actually tests
1	Solution Design & Architecture	17%	Translating business problems into Claude solutions; workflow vs. agentic patterns; multi-agent orchestration; decomposition; business-value alignment
2	Claude Models, Prompting & Context Engineering	13%	Model selection trade-offs; system prompts and guardrails; zero-/few-shot and chain-of-thought; context-window and token optimization; prompt caching, modular prompts, Skills
3	Integration	19%	Tool scope and capability bloat; authN/authZ gaps; accuracy–latency trade-offs; observability at scale; RAG pipeline, chunking, and retrieval strategy; MCP vs. API/CLI vs. agent-to-agent; progressive discovery vs. monolithic context
4	Evaluation, Testing & Optimization	16%	Metrics; eval datasets and mixed-method test frameworks; A/B testing; diagnosing prompt failures, hallucination, model mismatch; token/latency/cost optimization; logging and observability
5	Governance, Safety & Risk Management	14%	Guardrails and safety controls; failure modes; human-in-the-loop; GDPR / HIPAA / FedRAMP; bias, fairness, transparency
6	Stakeholder Communication & Lifecycle Management	14%	Structured discovery; communicating trade-offs; SLAs and expectation management; architecture documentation; discovery → design → handoff → monitoring → iteration
7	Developer Productivity & Operational Enablement	7%	Configuring Claude tooling for teams (e.g., Claude Code); AI-assisted developer workflows; debugging and operational issue resolution

Domain 3 (19%), Domain 1 (17%), and Domain 4 (16%) carry more than half the exam between them — budget your study time accordingly.

The official prep course (free)

Anthropic’s official prep path is **free to register** and mirrors the exam blueprint across five lessons (~12 hours total):

Lesson	Official duration	My video walkthrough
1 · Claude Platform & Solution Design	238 min	 Watch
2 · Enterprise Integration & Production	158 min	 Watch
3 · Responsible AI, Safety & Risk for Architects	114 min	 Watch

Lesson	Official duration	My video walkthrough
4 · Stakeholder Engagement, Lifecycle & GTM	178 min	 Watch
5 · Team Enablement & Operational Productivity	45 min	 Watch

👉 **Register for the official prep path (free)** — my video course follows the same five lessons, so you can use the two side by side.

Scoring, scheduling & policies — the short version

- **Criterion-referenced:** you pass by clearing the 720 cut score, not by beating other candidates. The cut score was set by a formal standard-setting study.
- **Registration:** through the Anthropic Partner Academy, then schedule with Pearson VUE (online proctored or a test center). Partner-tier discounts apply at checkout where applicable.
- **Reschedule/cancel:** free up to 24 hours before your appointment; inside 24 hours (or a no-show) forfeits the fee.
- **Retakes:** waiting periods grow with each failed attempt — 14 days, then 30, then 90 — with a maximum of four attempts in a rolling 12 months. The fee applies to every attempt.
- **Renewal:** the credential lasts 12 months. On-time renewal is a **free, non-proctored** refresher assessment; if it lapses, you retake the full exam at full price.
- **Exam day:** government photo ID matching your registration name exactly, clean workspace, webcam view throughout (if online), and you must accept a confidentiality/NDA agreement before starting. Accommodations must be approved by Pearson VUE *before* you schedule.

How I'd prepare

This is the approach I used for my own pass — **860 / 1,000** in September 2026 ([credential on Credly](#)):

1. **Watch the lessons** — [my free video course](#) and/or the official path, one lesson at a time.
2. **Self-assess against the blueprint** — read each objective above and honestly grade yourself.
3. **Build something real** — one end-to-end Claude solution with RAG, evals, and observability teaches more than any amount of reading.
4. **Read the official docs** — Claude API, model selection, prompt engineering, MCP, and Skills.
5. **Drill questions** — start with the [20 free samples](#) in this repo (or the [interactive quiz](#)), then work through the full 300-question bank on Udemy (*link coming soon*).

Official resources

- [CCAR-P prep path — Anthropic Partner Academy](#) (free registration)

- [Pearson VUE — Claude Certification Program](#) (scheduling, policies, accommodations)
 - [Anthropic documentation](#)
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